

TOPIC 5: Philippine-American War**List of Reading Materials:**

- **Account of Private William Grayson**
- **Address Adopted by Anti-Imperialist League**
- **Aguinaldo's Declaration of War**
- **Aguinaldo's Declaration of Surrender**
- **Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation**
- **Cartas Sobre La Revolucion**
- **Diary of Lt. Ernest Motsch**
- **Letter of Henry Thompson to his parents**
- **Correspondences relating to War with Spain**
- **Liberty Poems**

Introduction to the Philippine-American War

On 04 February 1899, two days prior to the US Congress' ratification of the 1898 Treaty of Paris war broke-out between the forces of the first Philippine Republic headed by President Emilio F. Aguinaldo and the American Forces in the country. The war was regarded as a continuation of the ongoing 1896 Philippine Revolution, while the United States simply regarded the conflict as an insurrection. The war led to the deaths of Filipino combatants and the fall of the first Philippine Republic. The war officially ended in July 1902.

This section contains primary and secondary sources that will help the students enrich their understanding and learning of the significant events that transpired during the Filipino-American War. Primary sources such as the account of Private Willian Grayson, Aguinaldo's Declaration of War, and the Address Adopted by Anti-Imperialist League provide a glimpse into the early parts of the war. On the other hand, secondary sources on the Filipino-American War in this section provides a historiographical understanding of the event.

Account of Private William Grayson ¹⁹

The Treaty of Paris of 1898 ended the Spanish-American War and decided on the fate of Spain's remaining colonies including the Philippines. For this, it was also of great importance to the Filipinos who had been fighting for their independence since 1896. Unfortunately, its contents were finalized without consulting with Aguinaldo's government, thereby amplifying suspicions regarding the true motives of the Americans in the Philippines. This eventually led to the outbreak of the Philippine-American War on February 4, 1899 – an event previously called the “San Juan Bridge Incident.” Further investigations later revealed that the first shot of the war occurred in Silencio cor. Sociego Streets in Santa Mesa, Manila.²⁰

One of the primary sources regarding this event was from Private William Walter Grayson, an American volunteer soldier of the First Nebraska Volunteer Infantry. From his own recollection of the encounter, it becomes clear that it was Grayson himself who fired the first shot which killed two Filipino soldiers. According to Teodoro Agoncillo, General Arthur MacArthur issued his order to advance against the Filipinos the day after this incident without even properly investigating the cause of the firing, thereby beginning the Philippine-American War.²¹

Private William Grayson, in an interview, said of this important incident:

“About eight o'clock, (Private Orville) Miller and I were cautiously pacing our district. We came to a fence and were trying to see what the Filipinos were up to. Suddenly, near at hand, on our left, there was a low but unmistakable Filipino outpost signal whistle. It was immediately answered by a similar whistle about twenty-five yards to the right. Then a red lantern flashed its signal from blockhouse No. 7. We had never seen such a sign used before.

In a moment something rose slowly up not twenty-five feet in front of us. It was a Filipino. I yelled ‘halt’ made it pretty loud, for I was accustomed to challenging the officer of the guard in

¹⁹ Edwin Wildman, *Aguinaldo: A Narrative of Filipino Ambitions* (Boston, Massachusetts: Lothrop Publishing Company, 1901), p. 195-196, accessed 25 October 2020, <http://name.umd.umich.edu/ahz9331.0001.001>.

²⁰ National Historical Institute, “Board Resolution 07, S. 2003: Authorizing the Transfer of the Historical Marker for the Site of the First Shot of the Philippine-American War from San Juan Bridge to Silencio corner Sociego St., Sta. Mesa, Manila,” accessed 25 October 2020, <https://drive.google.com/file/d/0B9c6mrxl4zoYRjU5VUVzRk1jaWs/view>.

²¹ Teodoro Agoncillo, *History of the Filipino People*, 8th edition (Quezon City: C&E Publishing, Inc., 2012), p. 226.

approved military style. I challenged him with another loud 'halt.' Then he shouted 'halto' to me. Well, I thought the best thing to do was to shoot him. He dropped. If I didn't kill him, I guess he died of fright. Then two Filipinos sprang out of the gateway about fifteen feet from us. I called 'halt' and Miller fired and dropped one. I saw that another was left. Well, I think I got my second Filipino that time.

We retreated to where our six other fellows were, and I said: 'Line up, fellows; the " niggers" are in here all through these yards.' We then retreated to the pipe line and got behind the water main and stayed there all night. It was some minutes after our second shots before the Filipinos began firing."

Address Adopted by the Anti-Imperialist League, February 10, 1899 ²²

In December 1898, US President William McKinley first openly declared his decision to annex the Philippines in his *Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation* which was shortly followed by the ratification of the Treaty of Paris on February 6, 1898. And while this plan to take over the Philippines received significant support from many Americans, a number of prominent citizens of the country, many of whom were politicians and intellectuals, still fearlessly expressed their opposition to the measure. In June 1898, these dissenters, which included former president Grover Cleveland, former senator George S. Boutwell, Stanford University's founding president David Starr Jordan, writer Mark Twain, and steel magnate and philanthropist Andrew Carnegie, formed the Anti-Imperialist League.

As a response to Filipino-American hostilities, this Boston-based league released a statement on February 10, 1898 which criticized the expansionist ideals of the US government as largely inconsistent with the founding principles of their country. It also warned that any further move to be committed by the Americans pertinent to the Philippines might endanger the security not only of the US but as well as of the entire world. The statement likewise beseeched the US government to acknowledge Aguinaldo as the rightful president of the Philippines and its congress as a legitimate representation of the people similar to the Continental Congress of the 13 British Colonies which later became the United States. In the end, the members of the league demanded the US government to withdraw its military forces from the Philippines and to instead recognize its independence.

10 February 1899

The full ratification of the Treaty with Spain will cause a technical change in the relations of the United States to the Philippine Islands, but will afford no- reason for any change of the purposes of the Anti-Imperialists in regard to the future of the islands, nor will it in the least affect the clear duty of this Republic.

We are now engaged in warfare with the inhabitants of those islands. It is unprofitable to discuss the question as to which party began hostilities. No other result could have been expected, when the lines of two opposing military forces were held so close and in such tense condition that little was needed to cause an explosion.

²² Anti-Imperialist League, *Address Adopted by the Anti-Imperialist League, February 10, 1899* (Boston, Massachusetts: Anti-Imperialist League, 1899), accessed 25 October 2020, <https://archive.org/details/addressadoptedby00anti>.

Certain facts, however, are beyond dispute: that Aguinaldo was brought to the islands by our own warship, that his aid was accepted and desired in our military operations against the Spaniards, and that hopes of independence were encouraged by our consuls and other officers. It is equally indisputable that a parliament of the islands, organized by representatives elected by 186 towns and provinces, chose Aguinaldo President and framed a constitution, which was promulgated, defining the powers and duties of the separate departments of the government with remarkable clearness and ability; that the government so formed beyond a doubt represented fairly the people of the islands and probably with quite as much fairness as the Continental Congress in Philadelphia, in 1775, represented the people of the thirteen States.

It is also undeniable that on January 5 President McKinley issued a proclamation through General Otis, declaring that on the 10th of the previous month the Philippine Islands had been ceded to this country by Spain by the signature of the Treaty of Paris, and further ordered him to extend the military government of the United States 'to the whole of the ceded territory,' and to demand the surrender of Iloilo, which was then held by the Filipinos in an orderly manner by capture from the Spaniards.

It cannot be claimed in law that this assumption of power was warranted in advance of the ratification of the Treaty by both parties, and there can be no doubt that the arbitrary claim greatly aggravated the people of the islands, whose hope of independence seemed thus rudely destroyed.

No declaratory resolution as to the future of the islands was assented to by the Administration before the ratification of the Treaty by the Senate, and none has been made since.

Any right that we assert to ownership of the Philippines must rest, therefore, either upon conquest or upon purchase from their Spanish oppressors, or upon both, and in any case it is, as we believe, inconsistent with the principles of this Republic, and fraught with danger to its peace and to the peace of the world.

The first result we already witness, a war of subjugation, which must embitter the people we seek to rule, and which, however successful, must bring disaster and death to our soldiers, and unmeasured cost to our people.

Profoundly impressed with the seriousness of the situation, it is the purpose of the Anti-Imperialists to continue the circulation of literature, to assist in the formation of leagues, and by public meetings, and every proper means known to a free people, to agitate for the revival in the

land of the spirit of Washington and Lincoln, to protest against a spirit of militarism and force, to oppose the colonial idea and a permanently large standing army, and to assert the vital truths of the Declaration of Independence embodied in the Constitution and indissolubly connected with the welfare of this Republic.

They urge, therefore, all lovers of freedom, without regard to party associations, to cooperate with them to the following ends:

First. That our government shall take immediate steps towards a suspension of hostilities in the Philippines and a conference with the Philippine leaders, with a view to preventing further bloodshed upon the basis of a recognition of their freedom and independence as soon as proper guarantees can be had of order and protection to property.

Second. That the Congress of the United States shall tender an official assurance to the inhabitants of the Philippine Islands that they will encourage and assist in the organization of such a government in the islands as the people thereof shall prefer, and that upon its organization in stable manner the United States, in accordance with its traditional and prescriptive policy in such cases, will recognize the independence of the Philippines and its equality among nations, and gradually withdraw all military and naval forces.

President Emilio Aguinaldo's Declaration of War on the United States (Malolos, Bulacan on February 4, 1899)

Following the conflict that erupted between the Philippine and American forces on 04 February 1899, at around nine o'clock p.m. President Emilio Aguinaldo received a communication from the Caloocan station regarding the event. He issued a declaration to the Filipino people saying that he had taken necessary actions to preserve the friendly ties between the Filipinos and the American forces, however, he said that the national integrity must be preserved as well. In this declaration, he also recognized that the American forces who were acting as friends and liberators unjustly attacked the Filipino forces. Aguinaldo issued three commands in his declaration: first, he ordered that all peace and friendly relations between the Filipino and American forces be severed and the latter be treated as enemies; second, the captured Americans will be treated as prisoners of war; and lastly, the declaration must be copy furnished to all the consuls in Manila and the Congress.

A copy of Aguinaldo's declaration is available in John Taylor's Philippine Insurgent Records. Taylor was a member of the United States Army in the Philippines. He was given appointed to be in charge of all the records seized by the American forces during the Philippine-American War. A compilation of these records came to known later on as the Philippine Insurgent Records.

Excerpt:

Nine o'clock p.m., this date, I received from Caloocan station a message communicated to me that the American forces, without prior notification or any just motive, attacked our camp at San Juan del Monte and our forces garrisoning the block-houses around the outskirts of Manila, causing the losses among our soldiers, who in view of this unexpected aggression and of the decided attack of the aggressors, were obliged to defend themselves until the firing became general all along the line. No one can deplore more than I this rupture of friendly relations. I have a clear conscience that I have endeavored to avoid it at all costs, using all my efforts to preserve friendship with the army of occupation, even at the cost of not a few humiliations and many sacrificed rights. But it is my unavoidable duty to maintain the integrity of the national honor and that of the army so unjustly attacked by those who, posing as our friends and liberators, attempted to dominate us in place of the Spaniards, as is shown by the grievances enumerated in my manifesto of January 8th last; such as the continued outrages and violent exactions committed against the people of Manila, the useless conferences, and all my frustrated efforts in favor of peace and concord.

Summoned by this unexpected provocation, urged by the duties imposed upon me by honor and patriotism and for the defense of the nation entrusted to me, calling on God as a witness of my good faith and the uprightness of my intentions, I order and command:

1. Peace and friendly relations between the Philippine forces and the American forces of occupation are broken, and the latter will be treated as enemies, within the limits prescribed by the laws of war.
2. American soldiers who may be captured by the Philippine forces will be treated as prisoners of war.
3. This proclamation shall be communicated to the accredited consuls of Manila, and to Congress, in order that it may accord the suspension of the constitutional guaranties and the resulting declaration of war.

Given at Malolos, February 4, 1899.

EMILIO AGUINALDO

General-in-Chief

Emilio Aguinaldo's Proclamation of Surrender to the United States, April 19, 1901 ²³

With the arrival of American reinforcements in March 1899, the United States' campaign against the Filipinos quickly gained momentum in many parts of the Philippines. Elwell Otis, the US Military Governor-General, order an intensive drive to the north with the aim of pursuing Emilio Aguinaldo who originally established his government in Malolos, Bulacan. On November 12, Tarlac, the last revolutionary capital, was captured by the Americans which signaled the collapse of organized Filipino resistance.²⁴ And with the fall of his top officials such as Mabini, Luna, and del Pilar, Aguinaldo was forced to flee to the mountains to avoid capture. Eventually, with the surrender of his personal messenger Cecilio Seguismundo and with the help of the Macabebes of Pampanga, Aguinaldo was arrested by Colonel Frederick Funston in Palanan, Isabela on March 23, 1901.

Aguinaldo was brought to Manila where he released a proclamation stating his official surrender to the United States on April 19. This was released by the office of Arthur MacArthur who succeeded Otis as the Governor-General. According to proclamation, Aguinaldo had to concede after he had chosen to heed the people's call for peace. It could be remembered that several members of Aguinaldo's own government eventually sided with the Americans and began to advocate for the annexation. At the end, he claimed that his official surrender was nevertheless a service for the Philippines.

Manila, P.I., April 19, 1901

The following address to the Filipino people is published for the information of all concerned. In order to signalize such important step in the pacification of the country, one thousand prisoners of war will, upon taking the oath of allegiance, be released and sent to their homes, for which purpose the Provost Marshal General will give the necessary orders.

ARTHUR MACARTHUR

Major General, US Army and US Military Governor in the Philippines

²³ Emilio F. Aguinaldo, "Address to the Filipino People: April 19, 1901," accessed 25 October 2020, <http://name.umd.umich.edu/adt4867.0001.001>.

²⁴ Frank H. Golay, *Face of the Empire: United States-Philippine Relations, 1898-1946* (Quezon City: Ateneo de Manila University Press, 1997), p. 53.

TO THE FILIPINO PEOPLE:

I believe I am not in error in presuming that the unhappy fate to which my adverse fortune has led me is not a surprise to those who have been familiar with the progress of the war. The lessons taught with a full meaning and which have recently come to my knowledge suggest with irresistible force that a complete termination of hostilities and lasting peace are not only desirable, but absolutely essential to the welfare of the Philippine Islands.

The Filipinos have never been dismayed at their weakness, nor have they faltered in following the path pointed out by their fortitude and courage. The time has come, however, in which they find their advance along this path to be impeded by an irresistible force, which, while it restrains them, yet enlightens their minds and opens to them another course, presenting them the cause of peace. This cause has been joyfully embraced by the majority of my fellow-countrymen, who have already united around the glorious sovereign banner of the United States. In this banner they repose their trust, and believe that under its protection the Filipino people will attain all those promised liberties which they are beginning to enjoy.

The country has declared unmistakably in favor of peace. So be it. There has been enough blood, enough tears, and enough desolation. This wish cannot be ignored by the men still in arms if they are animated by a desire to serve our noble people, which has thus clearly manifested its will. So do I respect this will, now that it is known to me.

After mature deliberation, I resolutely proclaim to the world that I cannot refuse to heed the voice of a people longing for peace, nor the lamentations of thousands of families yearning to see their dear ones enjoying the liberty and the promised generosity of the great American Nation.

By acknowledging and accepting the sovereignty of the United States throughout the Philippine Archipelago, as I now do, and without any reservation whatsoever, I believe that I am serving thee, my beloved country. May happiness be thine!

EMILIO AGUINALDO

Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation by US Willam McKinley, December 21, 1898. Retrieved from Blount, James. *American Occupation of the Philippines, 1898-1912*. (New York & London: G.P. Putnam's Sons, 1913)

The Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation issued by President William McKinley on December 21, 1898, is among the primary sources collated by James Blount, an American volunteer and district judge, during his sojourn in the Philippine archipelago in the early years of American occupation in the Philippine Archipelago by the turn of the 20th century. The compilation of the historical documents entitled *American Occupation of the Philippines, 1898-1912* is considered to be the culmination of Blount's anti-imperialist advocacy. Aside from offering a first-hand account of the Philippine American War and the early years of US colonization in the Philippines, the book attempts to offer a balance account of the period from the perspective of prominent figures in the Philippine-American War (such as George Dewey, Wesley Merritt, Elwell Otis and Emilio Aguinaldo, to name a few), alongside Blount's own interpretation to the turn of events that had taken place. As to the chief implementer of the Benevolent Assimilation, William McKinley was the 25th President of the United States of America who ran under the banner of the Republican Party whose main policy then involved the expansion of the power and influence of United States across the globe. The proclamation constitutes the official foreign policy of the Executive Arm of the US government in accordance to their aim in espousing their "Manifest Destiny" ideology and assuming the "white man's burden" role as their ways and means to justify their imperialist motives. Blount provided the historical background that led to the issuance of the proclamation and offered a scathing take which labels the proclamation as the "Pandora box of Philippine woes".

THE BENEVOLENT ASSIMILATION PROCLAMAION

EXECUTIVE MANSION, WASHINGTON,
December 21, 1898.

The destruction of the Spanish fleet in the harbor of Manila by the United States naval squadron commanded by the United States naval squadron commanded by Rear-Admiral Dewey, followed by the reduction of the city and the surrender of the Spanish forces, practically effected the conquest of the Philippine Islands and the suspension of Spanish sovereignty therein. With the signature of the treaty of peace between the United States and Spain by their respective plenipotentiaries at Paris on the 10th instant, and as a result of the victories of American arms, the future control, disposition, and government of the Philippine Islands are ceded to the United States. In the fulfillment of the rights of sovereignty thus acquired and the responsible obligations of government thus assumed, the actual occupation and administration of the entire group of the Philippine Islands becomes immediately necessary, and the military government heretofore maintained by the United States in the city, harbor, and bay of Manila is to be extended with all possible dispatch to the whole of the ceded territory. In performing this duty to the military commander of the United States is enjoined to make known to the inhabitants of the

Philippine Islands that in succeeding to the sovereignty of Spain, in severing the former political relations, and in establishing a new political power, the authority of the United States is to be exerted for the securing of the persons and property of the people of the islands and for the confirmation of all their private rights and relations. It will be the duty of the commander of the forces of occupation to announce and proclaim in the most public manner that we come not as invaders or conquerors, but as friends, to protect the natives in their homes, in their employments, and in their personal and religious rights. All persons who, either by active aid or by honest submission, co-operate with the Government of the United States to give effect to these beneficent purposes will receive the reward of its support and protection. All others will be brought within the lawful rule we have assumed, with firmness if need be, but without severity, so far as possible. Within the absolute domain of military authority, which necessarily is and must remain supreme in the ceded territory until the legislation of the United States shall otherwise provide, the municipal laws of the territory in respect to private rights and property and the repression of crime are to be considered as continuing in force, and to be administered by the ordinary tribunals, so far as practicable. The operations of civil and municipal government are to be performed by officers as may accept the supremacy of the United States by taking the oath of allegiance, or by officers chosen, as far as practicable, from the inhabitants of the islands. While the control of all the public property and the revenues of the state passes with the cession, and while the use and management of all public means of transportation are necessarily reserved to the authority of the United States, private property, whether belonging to the individuals or corporations, is to be respected except for cause duly established. The taxes and duties heretofore payable by the inhabitants to the late government become payable to the authorities of the United States unless it be seen fit to substitute for them other reasonable rates or modes of contribution to the expenses of government, whether general or local. If private property be taken for military use, it shall be paid for when possible in cash, at a fair valuation, and when payment in cash is not practicable, receipts are to be given. All ports and places in the Philippine islands in the actual possession of the land and naval forces of the United States will be opened to the commerce of all friendly nations. All goods and wares not prohibited for military reasons by due announcement of the military authority will be admitted upon payment of such duties and other charges as shall be in force at the time of their importation. Finally, it should be the earnest wish and paramount aim of the military administration to win the confidence, respect, and affection of the inhabitants of the Philippines by assuring them in every possible way that full measure of individual rights and liberties which is the heritage of free peoples, and by proving to them that the mission of the United States is one of Benevolent Assimilation substituting the mild sway of justice and right for arbitrary rule. In the fulfillment of this high mission, supporting the temperate administration of affairs for the greatest good of the governed, there must be sedulously maintained the strong arm of authority, to repress disturbance and to overcome all obstacles to the bestowal of the blessings of good and stable government upon the people of the Philippine Islands under the free flag of the United States.

WILLIAM MCKINLEY

Mariano Ponce's Cartas Sobre la Revolucion

Cartas Sobre la Revolucion, 1897-1900 is a compilation of letters and correspondences of Mariano Ponce to various revolutionaries – Filipinos and foreigners alike, from whom the former had interacted and asked support for the First Philippine Republic during the turbulent turn of the 20th century. Born in Baliuag Bulacan on March 23, 1863, Mariano Ponce is famous for being part of the “triumvirate” of the Filipino propagandista movement, alongside with Marcelo Del Pilar and Jose Rizal. In February 12, 1889, Ponce, together with Del Pilar and Graciano Lopez Jaena established *La Solidaridad* wrote various articles using the pen names of *Nanking*, *Kalipulako* and *Tikbalang*. Upon the establishment of the Hongkong Junta led by Emilio Aguinaldo, Ponce was appointed as the official representative of the Philippine revolutionary government to Japan for him to study the policy of Imperial Japan towards her relations to other nations, and subsequently, to ask for military and financial support. In his letter to G. Apacible dated in January 2, 1899, Ponce mentioned the negotiations being initiated for the acquisition of ammunitions from Japan and some diplomatic arrangements, among the others. Ponce's letter to Apacible in 1899, together with the other correspondences compiled, provide an outline of the conducts of the Philippine revolutionary government as far as diplomacy and international relations were concerned, thus, tracing its early relations to Asian nations, notably Japan and the reformist movement in China led by Dr. Sun Yat-sen. One could also discern from Ponce's letters the emerging Asian solidarity in response to the Western intrusion in the region for the past centuries. *Cartas Sobre la Revolucion, 1897-1900* is digitally housed in the *The United States and its Territories, 1870 – 1925: The Age of Imperialism* collection of the University of Michigan Library. Translation of the letters from Spanish to Filipino was undertaken by Professor Ma. Luisa Camagay and Professor Wylan dela Peña for its publication through the *Surian ng Wikang Filipino*.

115. LIHAM KAY APACIBLE

Mga negosasyon para sa mga armas. – Panibagong pagkaantala. – Ang mga kinatawang Filipino. – Palaging nagmamatyag ang mga Amerikano. – Paghahanap ng mga sundalo o opisyal sa hukbong reserbado ng Hapon.

637 Miyokoji Yama, Kitagata, Korakigun,
Yokohama, 2 Enero 1899.

Sr. Don G. APACIBLE,
Hongkong.

MAHAL KONG KAIBIGAN: Natanggap ko na ang iyong mga liham na may petsang ika-5, 9, 22, at 23 ng nakaraang Disyembre. Binasa kong mabuti ang lahat ng ito. Natanggap ko ang unang sulat mula sa mga komisyonadong sinalubong ko sa Kobe tulad ng nabalitaan ninyo sa pamamagitan ng aking *postcard*. Natanggap ko kasama ng huling sulat ang *letra de cambio* na may numero 176 na maipapalit sa Yokohama Specie Bank Ltd. Sa halagang 65.48 yen, bilang pagbabalik sa mga ginastos ko sa papel. Salamat dito. ayon sa inyong bilin, ilalagay ko bilang gastos ng representasyon dito ang mga kinuha ni Sr. G. Agoncillo. Padadalhan ko kayo ng listahan ng mga gastos dito sa susunod na liham. Wala akong panahon sa ngayon.

Tumuloy na sa San Francisco sina Sr. Luna, Sr. Lozada, at Sr. Marti noong ika-27 ng nakaraang buwan. Sinunod nila Heneral Riego at Sr. M. Rivera ang payo ng mga Hapones at naiwan sila rito. Nakatira sila sa bahay ninyo at ni Sr. Rivero. Bago umalis ang tatlong nabanggit, nakausap naming noong ika-23 ang isang taong may napakataas na posisyon sa kasalukuyang pamahalaan. Sinabi sa amin ng ginoong ito na hindi tatanggapin ng Hapon na masakop tayo ng ibang bansang makapangyarihan. Sinabi niyang natutuwa ang Hapon na gumaganda ang takbo ng ating Gobyerno at inaasam nito ang pagtatatag ng ating Republika. Hindi na siya makapagdagdag dito dahil isa siyang opisyal ng pamahalaan. Ngunit dahil itinataguyod niya ang kapayapaan, pinagpayuhan niya ang mga komisyonado na ituloy ang kanilang biyahe para sa propaganda sa Amerika at Europa, lalung-lalo na sa Inglatera at Alemanya. Walang dudang pakikilingan ng Amerika ang payo ng dalawang bansang ito. Tulad ng sinabi ko na sa inyo, higit na matutulugan tayo ng mga militar ngunit hindi tayo dapat magtaka na nagmula sa isang diplomatiko ang mga pangungusap na iyon. Hinggil naman sa kasalukuyang ginagawang negosasyon para sa mga armas, nagkaroon ng panibagong pagkaantala, ngayong pang hawak na namin ang 50 mil yen na ipinadala ninyo. Imposible kaming makakilos dahil walang tao rito mula noong Pasko. Bukod dito, palaging nagmamatyag ang mga Amerikano sa pagdating ng mga komisyonado. Ito ang pumipigil sa mga Hapon na bumuo ng isang mapanganib na desisyon. Sinasabing dapat nilang makuhang pagkatiwalaan muli ng mga Amerikano tulad ng dati bago sila kumilos. Lubos naming ikinalulungkot ito. upang madaliin ang takbo ng mga pangyayari, ipinaiwan namin dito si Heneral Riego. Hinihintay naming ngayon ang ika-8 sa pagbalik ng mga nagsipagbakasyon at muli naming lalakaran ang bagay na ito. kapag natapos na ang mga nakabimbing negosasyon at narito na ang hahalili sa akin, uuwi na ako dahil ito rin ang kagustuhan ng ating Presidente. Naghahanap kami ng mga sundalong retirado o nasa hukbong reserbado na gustong sumama. Dapat maganda ang kanilang ugali, marunong ng Ingles o Pranses, at hindi mahirap pakisamahan. Hindi ito pagsasantabi ng mga opisyal na maaring ibigay sa ating pamahalaan. Sinabi sa akin ng Direktor ng Giyera sa isang liham na may 50 ang kailagan doon. Mahihirapan ang pamahalaan na bigyan tayo ng ganoon karaming mga opisyal. Binabati ko kayo ng Manigong Bagong Taon at muli nagsasabing isa ninyong magili na kaibigan at kasama si

M. PONCE.

Diary Entry of Lt. Aime Ernest Motsch (also known as Lieutenant X) on the Siege of Manila during the War in the Philippines in 1898

The Siege of Manila Diary Entry of Lieutenant Aime Ernest Motsch is part of his diary entries about the War in the Philippines in the 1898 which were translated from French to English by Marietta Enriquez-de la Haye Jouselin. 21 years old at that time, Lt. Motsch (who was also known by his pseudonym of “Lieutenant X”), was the officer in charge of the only French battleship docked in the Manila Bay, the *Bruix*, alongside with the other European empires who were “observing” the suspenseful turn of events of the wars amongst the Spaniards, Americans and Filipinos. His diary dating from April 28 to August 31, 1898, fleshed out the specifics of the battles, its aftermath and the general sentiments of the political actors involved in the war theater that was the Spanish-American War. Aside from the diary entries providing firsthand account and thus, can be used to corroborate other primary sources pertaining to the Siege of Manila, for instance, perhaps the strength of Lt. X account as a historical document draws from its “spontaneity” and “unofficial nature” as what Jouselin noted “ [the entries] reveal the man behind the military officer, watching the battle in progress, and freely expressing his reactions and opinions.” However, one should also take a grain of salt when reading and using Lt. X entries as there are evidences of lower treatment towards the natives can be gleaned (ie: use of the term “insurgent” instead of “revolution” in labelling the Filipino faction in the war).

SIEGE OF MANILA

Sunday, 29 May

The blockade of Manila is now a month old.

The weather will worsen. The Americans have not planted their strategy against the city. They are waiting for the ground troops to arrive from San Francisco. Meanwhile, the insurgents have taken up arms, each day coming closer to Manila, where the Spaniards have allowed themselves to be hemmed in. There will be enough time for action when the Americans disembark.

In the bay, we see the English who seem to be well positioned beside Admiral Dewey’s squadron, the Germans giving the impression that they have a strategy, the Japanese who come and go, and the French who wait, observing, fully aware that their presence will not influence the coming events.

Each fleet is preoccupied with protecting its nationals. On Thursday morning the French delegates came on board, led by the consul and a French engineer who works at the *Compagnie Generale des Tabacs*. We discussed the arrangements: the engineer can provide us with a company ship for transporting the maximum number of men, along with their valuable possessions and provisions, when the attack is confirmed. We think that this will happen anytime now. The ship will therefore come alongside and be protected by our cannons. There is room for a large number of persons. France is protecting the Greeks, the Rumanians, the Valaques, and all her former Levantine clientele – without continuing the Turks. Many women of easy virtue are

from the Levant. They pretend to be Moldo- Valaques, but whether they are or not, they also need our protection. The fear of bombing poses a great number of social problems.

Essentially, the insurgents are at the moment the masters of the situation. It is their word which prevails on land. They are feared by the Spaniards and have given their support to the Americans. Can the Spaniards' travail be taken seriously? Everything they do could be merely to give the impression that they alone have prepared defensive measures.

Monday, May 30

This morning, at 6 o'clock, I went on shore with a comrade. We visited the markets of Binondo and San Miguel. There is an enormous crowd of Tagals and Chinese. Baskets full of fish and delicious fruits are everywhere. The smell of the Chinese overpowers even that of the sea. There is an abundance of lively colors and movements. The looks directed at us are either sympathetic or indifferent, but not at all hostile. The streets are swarming with people discussing among themselves, keeping pace with the tempo on the streets without stopping for a single moment to reflect on the present catastrophe before them.

-And yet, someone said to us an hour later, the fighting began this morning, very early, at Las Piñas, at the very threshold of Manila. The insurgents are putting less and less distance between themselves and the Spaniards with each passing moment. Before long, the two will be at each other's throats.

-What exactly do the insurgents want?

-The other day there was an important meeting between the Philippine chiefs and the high officials in Manila, in which Aguinaldo was supposed to have been the spokesman for his side. He simply stated that his men were well armed, a fact the Spaniards are quite aware of since they themselves had armed the Tagals a month ago. They seemed pleased with themselves that the insurgents of a year ago are now on their side against the Americans. In spite of everything, Aguinaldo is alleged to have offered his assistance, provided that three conditions be followed: 1) the expulsion of all religious orders; 2) the transfer of all ecclesiastical goods, furniture, and buildings for the civil use of the Filipinos; 3) absolute autonomy. This is what is being rumored around, but there is no truth to it. Aguinaldo is in Cavite, brought there from Hongkong by the Americans. In the city, the foreigners are getting worried. This is an absurd situation which cannot go on any longer. Tomorrow the ships which have been chartered will leave the river. The trunks are fast and secure and the final pieces of baggage are being put on board.

-And what is the news from Europe?

-The opinions one hears in the city are that the European powers will provide help. We are confident of Germany. I have received a report from a Hongkong correspondent that a naval battle can be expected. Details of the expected American defeat are not yet known, and Europe is preparing to intervene at the earliest opportunity.

Letter of Henry Thompson to his parents dated 8 February 1899, published in *Inside the Fighting First: Papers of a Nebraska Private in the Philippine War*, edited by Thomas Solevad Nielsen, (Nebraska: Lur Publications, Danish Immigrant Archive, Dana College, 2001), 98-99.

Thomas Nielsen's "Inside the Fighting First: Papers of a Nebraska Private in the Philippine War" contains Private Henry O. Thompson's letters and diary entries during the course of the Philippine-American War. After Thompson's death, his family donated the materials to the Danish Immigrant Archive at Dana College, Nebraska. Thomas Nielsen, editor from the archive, worked on the materials and submitted the edited version to the Lur Publications. Private Thompson left his farming life to volunteer for the Pacific Battle as part of the Co K, 1st Regiment Nebraska Volunteers. Henry Thompson's letters were unedited, resulting in the presence of errors. Although there were grammatical errors, the unedited version reflected more the voice of the writer. Nielsen attributed the grammatical and spelling errors to Private Thompson's shift from the Danish to the English language. Private Thompson was born to Danish immigrant parents. In one of the letters addressed to his parents, Private Thompson narrated their company encounter with the Filipinos on 4 February 1899. The letter corroborated Private William Grayson's account. Most of the historical accounts had used the testimony of Private Grayson to present the start of the Philippine-American War. While the official report of the government blamed the Filipinos, the letter of Private Thompson and the testimony of Private Grayson attested that their group fired the first shot.

Dear Parents,

I will write a few lines to you to let you know that I am well after the fight we had last Saturday night, and all Sunday and Monday afternoon. I tell you we had a hot time fighting those black insurgents. But, we made them run just like jackrabbits. Then shot them as fast as we could. Our guns were so hot that we burned our fingers on them. Today we have the insurgents clear back to the mountains. How many we have killed of them I don't know, but they say from 5 to 10 thousand of them. Out of Co M we had 1 man killed. His name is Guy Livingstone of Pallesmouth, Nebraska. We had 3 wounded, but not bad. Our company made a charge Sunday morning just as it was getting light, on bamboo thicket which was full of insurgents. Next day they found 80 insurgents killed there. I can tell you that Cornie Egan of St. Edwards got killed Sunday morning. Now I will tell you what time the fight started. On outpost Number 2 and Post 2, there is where the first shot was fired by a Nebraskan boy of Co. D. He shot and killed an insurgent lieutenant who was coming up the road with some other insurgents. They wouldn't halt when the guard called to them to, so he had to shoot them. Then you ought to have heard the bugles blow the call to arms. And the insurgents started to shoot as fast as they could all around us. It was then 9 o'clock Saturday evening. Kept the fight up for about 2 hours. Then it stopped, but to begin again at 3 o'clock Sunday morning and kept it going all day until 3 o'clock in the afternoon. When we had made the insurgent's retreat, it was 11 o'clock. We had to drive them out of a blockhouse and of the bridge. We done by 11 o'clock. Then it went along all right. The insurgents retreated as fast they could back about 2 miles. There we stopped for a rest in the

buildings that they just left. Then we got a little piece of bread to eat. We had not anything to eat since Saturday night. We were tired and sleepy. Some of us lay down to sleep right on the ground with our heads on our haversacks, which had a few bullets in them yet. The Tennessee's one battalion of them came after us and they started after the insurgents then. And 6 insurgents jumped out of the road and held up their hands, and a white flag. But the Tennessee's just shot them before they could say a word. We got a lot of prisoners. All day Monday our company had to bury the dead insurgents around block house no. 7 we buried over 20 of them – 3 or 4 in each grave. I guess you have read all about the war in the papers before you get this letter so you know how many we have killed. I have not got much time to write now. I have been up all the time since Saturday morning until Tuesday night was the first night that I slept all night without getting up and going around on guard. I look so dirty and tired that if you could see me you wouldn't know me. All the boys look alike. We ain't had time to wash for 2 days and 3 nights in which time we was in fight. Well I will tell you about it when I come home. Well I got a chance to shoot at a Filipino., if I didn't get a shot at a Spaniard. One thing I don't know that is how many I shot and killed. Well that is all. I am well. Good bye.

My best regards to all of you,

Henry

Correspondences relating to the War with Spain and Conditions Growing out of the same, Including the Insurrection in the Philippine Islands and the China Relief Expedition Between the Adjutant-General of the Army and Military Commanders in the United States, Cuba, Porto Rico, China, and the Philippine Islands, from April 15, 1898 to July 30, 1902. Washington: Government Printing Office, 1902, page 894.

This is a compilation of official documents pertaining to the military affairs of the United States during the Spanish-American, Philippine-American Wars and military operations in China. It includes exchanges of correspondences between the Adjutant-General of the Army (Major General Henry C. Corbin) and the Military Commanders in Cuba, Porto Rico, China and the Philippines during the course of the said wars. It also included some of the related responses and instructions from the Secretary of War and the President of the United States. The Americans belittled the Philippine incident as an insurrection, hence the title of the compilation. However, the Filipinos considered it as a war. The Anti-Imperialists would call it a war of criminal aggression. Some of the military documents included in this compilation are incident reports during the Philippine-American War, such as the encounter between the American and Filipino forces on the night of 4 February 1899. The reports of Philippine Military Governor Elwell Otis to the Adjutant-General as well as that of Secretary Elihu Root to the President were both brief. It is apparent in the letter of Governor Elwell Otis dated 5 February 1899 that he blamed the Filipinos as instigators of the war. Hence, since his report was what the United States Army Adjutant-General received, this report in turn became the basis of Secretary of War Elihu Root's report to President William McKinley. These two reports, however, are contradictory to the account of Private William Grayson and the letter of Private Henry Thompson.

General Otis' incident report to the Adjutant-General in Washington dated 5 February 1899, saying that the insurgents attacked the Americans.

Insurgents in large force opened attack on our outer lines at 8:45 last evening. Renewed attack several times during night. At 4 o'clock this morning entire line engaged. All attacked repulsed. At daybreak advanced against insurgents and have driven them beyond the lines they formerly occupied, capturing several villages and their defense works. Insurgents loss in dead and wounded large. Our own casualties thus far estimated at 175, very fatal few. We are still driving enemy and think we shall punish them severely. Troops enthusiastic and acting fearlessly. Navy did splendid execution on flanks of enemy. City held in check and absolute quiet prevails. Believe that insurgent army attacked contrary wishes of their government. Insurgents have secured good many Mauser rifles, a few field pieces, and quick firing guns, with ammunition, during last month.

The official report that reached the President of the United States, written by Secretary of War Elihu Root stated that

On the night of February 4th, two days before the U.S. Senate approved the treaty, an army of Tagalogs, a tribe inhabiting the central part of Luzon, under the leadership of Aguinaldo, a Chinese half-breed, attacked, in vastly superior numbers, our little army in the possession of Manila, and after a desperate and bloody fight was repulsed in every direction.

Liberty Poems. James West Company, 1900, pp13-15; 63-64

In June 1900, The James West Company of Boston had published a book entitled *Liberty Poems*. It was a collection of poems written by notable anti-imperialists such as William Lloyd Garrison, Ernest Crosby, William Vaughn Moody, James Dooling, Clarence Hawkes, W. A. Croffut and others. Some were published in the Anti-Imperialist League newspapers such as Boston Evening Transcript, Sunday Republican, Springfield Republican. Inscribed on the cover of the book was “inspired by the crisis of 1898-1900” and was “made for the New England Anti-Imperialist League,” through the efforts of the “supporters of the cause of freedom.” What was noticeable in the poems were some of the words used by the soldiers in their letters. Included in the rhetoric of the writers were words like “jack-rabbit,” “goo-goos,” “Injun,” “nigger” in referring to the Filipinos and orders like “take no prisoners,” and “spare no one” and some soldiers terms like “war is hell,” “war is fun.” In addition, the anti-imperialists wrote about the experiences of the soldiers in the field as narrated by the soldiers to their loved ones. One particular entry was Ernest Crosby’s *The Pirate Flag*, which talks about the soldiers accounts about the war as fun, about the looting, about the burning of villages, and about the manslaughter. Crosby wrote about the orders of officers, who despite the waging of white flag of the revolutionary forces, they still killed them because of the “no prisoners” policy during the war. Crosby also alluded to the looting and the plunder that the soldiers, whom he called as “Blue-jackets and marines” in the Philippines. In one stanza, Crosby parodied the men who did the lootings and the killings mistaking them as pirates where in reality, “they were Dewey’s men.”

The Pirate’s Flag

By Ernest Crosby

And then around me fore and aft
 The guns began to roar,
 And flames sprang up and soon enwrapped
 A village on the shore.
 I took my glass, and clearly saw
 Women and children run,
 While soldiers in the palms behind
 Were potting them for fun.

Far to the left some dusky men
Fought bravely on a knoll;
But, overcome at last, they raised
A white rag on a pole.
Yet still the soldiers shot them down;
And I could almost hear
Their laughter as they seemed to shout,
“No prisoners wanted here!”

Then, when the last defender fell,
The men rushed in with glee;
And from each house they came with loads
Of plunder, sad to see.
And soon we sent a boat ashore,
Blue-jackets and marines,
To get our share of loot and swag,
And spoil the Philippines.

I turned and asked a sailor lad,
For now they stood at ease,
What pirates we might chance to be
Who plagued these summer seas.
“Oh, we’re no pirates,” he replied.
Don’t ask me that again.
This is a ship of Uncle Sam,
And we are Dewey’s men.”

“But how is that?” I said once more.
“Where are your stripes and stars?
And does that inky flag up there

Belong to honest tars?"

"To tell the truth, it's rather queer,"

Replied embarrassed Jack.

"But something in the climate here

Has turned Old Glory black.

The work of Francis Ellingwood Abbot entitled "Old Glory" – "New Shame," was more intense in accusing the American government of "filthing the flag with mud" due to its imperialistic desire.

"Old Glory", - "New Shame"

By Francis Ellingwood Abbot

Are we wild wolves, then,
Gorged in our den?

Look to your flag, O Freedom's men!
Tis filthy with mud,
Soaked with innocent blood,
Loathed of the free and abhorred of God.

Shame on this lust
For the golden dust,
For "commerce" and "markets" in which fools trust!
Shame on this wars
Of Plutus and Mars-
Stripes and Dollars, not Stripes and Stars!

Drunken and gory,
Damn not the proud story
That shines in each stripe and each star of "Old Glory"!
The great Declaration

That made us a NATION-
'Tis hissed but by vipers of this generation.
Shall cant, murder, greed,
Blacken Freedom's bright creed?
Look to it, men of Freedom's breed!
Wash clean your aim,
Wash your smirched name,
Wash from "Old Glory" the foul "New Shame"!